

DDoS incidents Report

Five recent DDoS attacks

1. **Cloudflare (May 2025)** – A record-breaking DDoS attack reaching 7.3 Tbps. Cloudflare stopped it before any damage.
2. Cloudflare (April 2025) – Another big DDoS attack of 6.5 Tbps, using billions of packets per second.
3. Cloudflare (mid-2025) – Attacks reaching over 11 Tbps, showing DDoS sizes are increasing.
4. Microsoft (July 2024) – A DDoS attack that helped cause a big Microsoft 365 and Azure outage worldwide.
5. NoName057(16) Group (2025) – A pro-Russian hacker group used DDoS attacks against websites in Ukraine and allied countries before being caught by Europol.

Chosen Attack: Cloudflare 7.3 Tbps Attack (May 2025)

❖ Target

A hosting company that used Cloudflare's protection system called *Magic Transit*.

❖ Technology used

- ❖ The attackers used a **UDP flood**..they sent huge amounts of fake internet traffic (about **7.3 terabits per second**) in a short burst.
- ❖ The traffic came from many infected computers and devices (a botnet).
- ❖ It lasted around 45 seconds but was powerful enough to crash normal networks.

❖ Attacker's motive

The exact reason is not known, but possible motives include:

- ❖ Testing or showing off hacking power.
 - ❖ Trying to cause disruption or extort money.
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❖ Impact

- ❖ No downtime occurred because Cloudflare's system automatically blocked it.
- ❖ If not stopped, it could have **shut down the company's websites** and affected users worldwide.
- ❖ It proved that modern DDoS attacks are getting faster and stronger.

❖ Defensive strategies

1. **Use DDoS protection services** like they absorb and filter bad traffic.
2. **Anycast network** — spreads traffic across many servers around the world, so no single server crashes.
3. **ISP cooperation** — internet providers should block fake traffic early.
4. **Better IoT security** — many DDoS attacks use hacked smart devices (CCTV, routers, etc.). Keeping them secure helps stop botnets.
5. **Automatic detection** — systems that notice strange traffic and block it quickly.